

Republican journey: on the President's address to the nation

The President should **stay clear of partisan** political **discourse**

In her **customary** address to the nation **on the eve of** the 76th Republic Day, **the President of India**, Droupadi Murmu, **said** that the Constitution has become a living document due to the **millennia-old civic virtues** of the country. Ms. Murmu also **paid tribute to** Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, who **chaired** the Drafting Committee, and other members of the Constituent Assembly, who created a document that would guide the country's progress. Connecting India's journey as a modern Republic to its heritage, the President said the constitutional values of justice, liberty, equality, and **fraternity** have always been a part of India's civilisation. **Sceptics** who doubted India's **prospects** at the time of Independence **have** been proven wrong due to these **inherent** strengths of the country. The President **highlighted** the representative character of the Constituent Assembly, whose members were drawn from every part of, and communities in, the country, including 15 women. While women's equality was at that time only a **distant ideal** in much of the world, Indian women were contributing to shaping the nation's destiny, she noted. **Reflecting on** the progress over 75 years, Ms. Murmu **commended** the Union government's efforts to move past the **relics** of the **colonial era**, particularly the "**audacity of vision**" of replacing colonial-era criminal laws with three new laws **rooted in** Indian traditions of **jurisprudence**.

The President strongly **advocated** the controversial proposal for **simultaneous** elections to the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies as a **means to redefine** good **governance**. **The draft Bill** on simultaneous elections, introduced by the Narendra Modi government, **is** under review by a joint committee of Parliament. The President **waded** into the debate with the argument that **synchronised** elections would promote consistency in governance, prevent policy **paralysis**, **mitigate** resource diversion, and reduce financial burdens. It is a **contentious** topic and Opposition parties that are a part of the Indian National Developmental Inclusive **Alliance** have opposed the plan **on the ground that** it violates the basic structure of the Constitution and **undermines federalism**. Not surprisingly, Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge has **alleged** that there is a "**tendency**" to **impose** a "One Nation, One Party" agenda by undermining the Opposition. The President could have stayed clear of this topic. The government will need to **tread** carefully to ensure that the First Citizen is not **drawn** into what is essentially a partisan political debate. Unity without **uniformity** is **key** to a more perfect union. And Republic Day is as good as any other day to **reiterate** that.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Address** (noun) – speech, talk, statement, communication, oration संबोधन
2. **Stay clear of** (phrase) – avoid, steer clear of, keep away from, refrain from, dodge से बचना / दूर रहना
3. **Partisan** (adjective) – biased, one-sided, prejudiced, partial, sectarian पक्षपाती
4. **Discourse** (noun) – discussion, conversation, dialogue, debate, exchange विमर्श
5. **Customary** (adjective) – usual, traditional, habitual, conventional, routine पारंपरिक
6. **On the eve of** (phrase) – just before, prior to, in advance of, on the threshold of, preceding से ठीक पहले
7. **Millennia-old** (adjective) – ancient, age-old, time-honoured, centuries-old, very old सहस्राब्दी पुराना
8. **Civic** (adjective) – civil, municipal, community-related, public, societal नागरिक
9. **Virtue** (noun) – goodness, moral excellence, righteousness, integrity, merit सद्गुण
10. **Pay tribute to** (phrase) – honour, praise, salute, acknowledge, commend सम्मान प्रकट करना
11. **Chair** (verb) – preside over, head, lead, oversee, moderate अध्यक्षता करना
12. **Fraternity** (noun) – brotherhood, fellowship, camaraderie, association, community भाईचारा
13. **Sceptic** (noun) – doubter, cynic, questioner, disbeliever, agnostic संदेहवादी
14. **Prospect** (noun) – possibility, likelihood, potential, outlook, chance संभावना
15. **Inherent** (adjective) – intrinsic, innate, built-in, essential, natural अंतर्निहित
16. **Highlight** (verb) – emphasize, underline, stress, spotlight, underscore जोर देना
17. **Distant** (adjective) – far-off, remote, far away, out of reach, separated दूरस्थ
18. **Ideal** (noun) – principle, standard, value, model, aspiration आदर्श
19. **Reflect** (on) (verb) – think about, ponder, contemplate, consider, mull over चिंतन करना
20. **Commend** (verb) – praise, applaud, compliment, endorse, approve सराहना करना
21. **Relics** (noun) – remnants, vestiges, remains, traces, artifacts निशानी
22. **Colonial** (adjective) – imperial, of or relating to a colony, involving imperial rule, occupant, from the colonial period उपनिवेशी

23. **Era** (noun) – period, age, epoch, time, span
युग
24. **Audacity** (noun) – boldness, daring, courage, fearlessness, nerve दुस्साहस
25. **Root** (in) (verb) – base upon, ground in, embed in, originate from, establish in जड़ित होना
26. **Jurisprudence** (noun) – legal theory, law, legal system, judicial principle, legal philosophy न्यायशास्त्र
27. **Advocate** (verb) – support, recommend, champion, argue for, back समर्थन करना
28. **Simultaneous** (adjective) – concurrent, parallel, synchronous, coexisting, at the same time एक साथ होने वाला
29. **Means** (noun) – method, way, tool, mechanism, medium साधन
30. **Redefine** (verb) – reevaluate, reimagine, reinterpret, revise, transform पुनर्परिभाषित करना
31. **Governance** (noun) – administration, management, control, government, leadership शासन व्यवस्था
32. **Wade** (verb) – step into, get involved (in), venture into, plunge into, move through प्रवेश करना
33. **Synchronise** (verb) – coordinate, align, match up, harmonize, happen at the same time समकालीन बनाना
34. **Paralysis** (noun) – immobility, standstill, inability to act, stagnation, inactivity निष्क्रियता
35. **Mitigate** (verb) – alleviate, reduce, lessen, ease, moderate कम करना
36. **Contentious** (adjective) – controversial, debatable, disputable, argumentative, divisive विवादास्पद
37. **Alliance** (noun) – partnership, coalition, association, union, bloc गठबंधन
38. **On the ground that** (phrase) – because, for the reason that, on the basis that, due to, given that इस आधार पर कि
39. **Undermine** (verb) – weaken, sabotage, subvert, erode, diminish कमजोर करना
40. **Federalism** (noun) – system of shared governance, union of states, federated structure, dual governance model, federal structure संघवाद
41. **Allege** (verb) – claim, assert, contend, declare, accuse आरोप लगाना
42. **Tendency** (noun) – inclination, propensity, leaning, trend, bias प्रवृत्ति
43. **Impose** (verb) – force, inflict, enforce, thrust upon, foist थोपना

44. **Tread** (verb) – proceed carefully, step, walk,
move carefully, navigate सावधानीपूर्वक चलना

45. **Draw** (verb) – pull, attract, involve, bring in,
engage खींचना

46. **Uniformity** (noun) – consistency, sameness,
homogeneity, standardization, conformity
एकरूपता

47. **Key** (adjective) – crucial, essential, important,
pivotal, vital महत्वपूर्ण

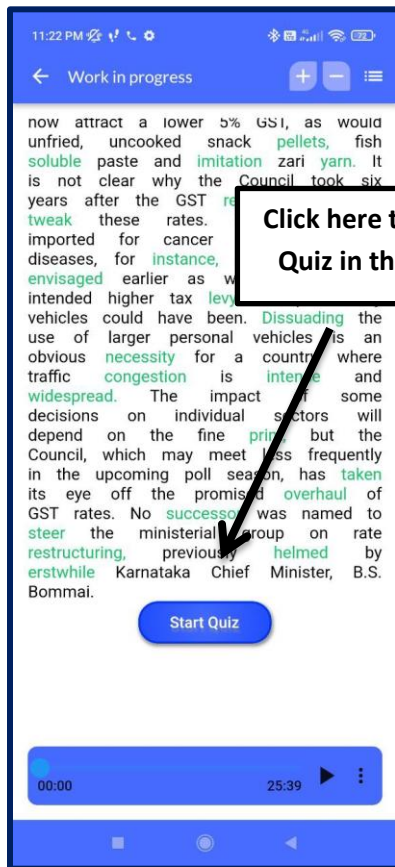
48. **Reiterate** (verb) – repeat, restate, say again,
emphasize again, reaffirm दोहराना

@mocks_wallah

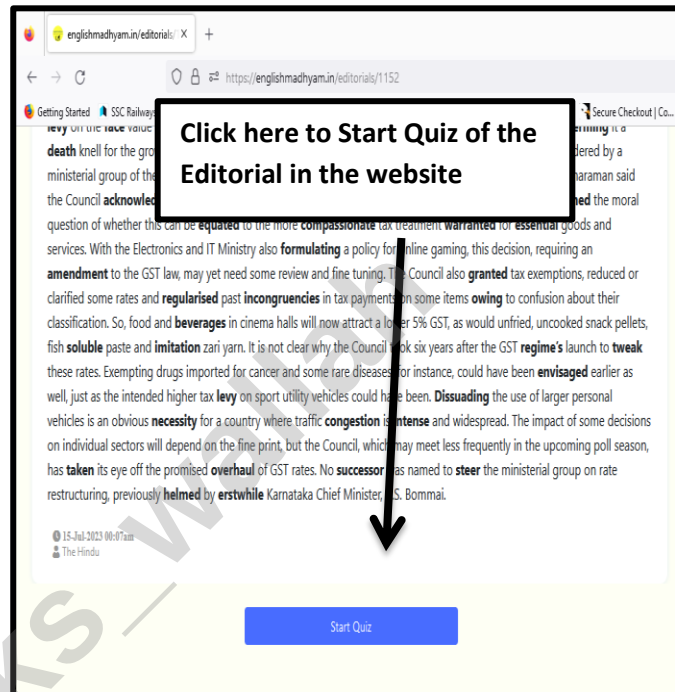
Summary of the Editorial

1. **President's Address:** On the eve of the 76th Republic Day, President Droupadi Murmu delivered her customary address, highlighting India's constitutional journey and heritage.
2. **Living Constitution:** She emphasized that the Constitution is a "living document," enriched by India's millennia-old civic virtues.
3. **Tribute to Founders:** The President paid homage to Dr. B.R. Ambedkar and other Constituent Assembly members for drafting the guiding document of the Republic.
4. **Values in Civilisation:** Constitutional principles like justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity have deep roots in India's civilizational ethos, according to the President.
5. **Proven Sceptics Wrong:** The President noted that India has defied sceptics who doubted its potential post-Independence, attributing this to its inherent cultural and democratic strengths.
6. **Inclusivity of Constitution:** The representative nature of the Constituent Assembly, which included members from all parts and communities of the country, was highlighted.
7. **Women's Contribution:** The President celebrated the contributions of 15 women in the Constituent Assembly, showcasing India's progressive ideals, even when women's equality was a distant goal globally.
8. **Colonial Era Reforms:** Ms. Murmu commended the Union government's efforts to replace colonial-era criminal laws with new ones rooted in Indian traditions.
9. **Simultaneous Elections Proposal:** The President strongly endorsed the contentious proposal for simultaneous elections to the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies as a tool for good governance.
10. **Benefits of Synchronisation:** She argued that simultaneous elections could ensure governance consistency, prevent policy paralysis, reduce financial burdens, and mitigate resource diversion.
11. **Contentious Nature:** The proposal is controversial, with Opposition parties in the INDIA bloc opposing it as unconstitutional and a threat to federalism.
12. **Opposition Criticism:** Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge criticized the idea, alleging it aligns with a "One Nation, One Party" agenda, undermining democratic diversity.
13. **Partisan Concerns:** The President's endorsement of this proposal risks drawing the First Citizen into partisan debates, which could compromise the non-political nature of the office.
14. **Unity in Diversity:** The editorial stresses that unity without uniformity is essential for building a stronger and more inclusive nation.
15. **Call for Prudence:** The government must exercise caution to ensure the President's office remains neutral, avoiding involvement in divisive political discourse.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



Click here to Start
Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the
Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam